Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

Phase 4 - Project Planning Phase

1. Planning Overview

The **Project Planning Phase** defines how the **"Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)"** project will be executed, monitored, tested, and completed.

The main goal of the project is to create a structured process for importing spreadsheet data into a ServiceNow target table using **Import Sets and Transform Maps**.

The planning phase identifies the project objectives, scope, resources, activities, timeline, responsibilities, risks, testing strategy, and expected deliverables.

2. Project Objective

The primary objective of this project is to develop a reliable and efficient mechanism to import bulk data from a spreadsheet into ServiceNow.

The project aims to:

- Import spreadsheet data into ServiceNow.
- Use Import Sets to stage the source data.
- Use Transform Maps to map source fields to target fields.
- Transform data when required.
- Validate imported data.
- Handle duplicate records using Coalesce.
- Identify and handle import errors.
- Reduce manual data-entry effort.
- Improve data accuracy and consistency.

3. Project Scope

In Scope

The following activities are included in the project:

- Preparing the spreadsheet template.
- Configuring the Data Source.
- Creating an Import Set.
- Creating an Import Set Table.
- Creating a Transform Map.
- Configuring field mappings.
- Configuring Coalesce fields.

- Implementing transformation logic.
- Performing data validation.
- Handling import errors.
- Testing the complete import process.
- Verifying records in the target table.
- Documenting the import procedure.

Out of Scope

The following activities are outside the scope:

- Developing a completely new external application.
- Designing complex integrations with third-party systems.
- Large-scale data migration from multiple unrelated systems.
- Major customization of the ServiceNow platform.
- Advanced automation beyond the defined spreadsheet import process.

4. Project Activities

The project will be divided into several activities.

Activity 1 – Requirement Analysis

Identify and document:

- Source spreadsheet structure.
- Required fields.
- Target table requirements.
- Field mapping requirements.
- Data transformation requirements.
- Duplicate handling requirements.
- Validation and error-handling requirements.

Activity 2 – Spreadsheet Preparation

Prepare a standard spreadsheet template containing the required fields.

Example:

Field	Description
Employee ID	Unique employee identifier
Employee Name	Employee's full name
Email	Employee email address
Department	Employee department

Field	Description
Joining Date	Employee joining date

Activity 3 – ServiceNow Configuration

Configure the required ServiceNow components:

- Data Source.
- Import Set.
- Import Set Table.
- Target Table.
- Transform Map.

Activity 4 – Field Mapping

Map spreadsheet fields to ServiceNow target fields.

Example:

```
Employee ID       → Employee ID
Employee Name     → Name
Email             → Email
Department        → Department
Joining Date      → Date of Joining
```

Activity 5 – Transformation Configuration

Define transformation rules for:

- Date conversion.
- Text formatting.
- Reference values.
- Empty values.
- Business-specific data conversion.

Activity 6 – Duplicate Handling

Configure **Coalesce** using a unique field such as Employee ID.

The system should:

- Update an existing record when the identifier already exists.
- Create a new record when the identifier does not exist.

Activity 7 – Testing

Test the import process using different spreadsheet scenarios.

Testing should include:

- Valid records.
- Invalid records.
- Missing mandatory fields.
- Duplicate records.
- Existing records.
- New records.
- Incorrect data formats.
- Large data volumes.

Activity 8 – Deployment and Verification

After successful testing:

- Finalize the Transform Map.
- Perform the import.
- Verify target records.
- Review import results.
- Confirm that errors are handled correctly.
- Document the final configuration.

5. Project Timeline

A sample project timeline can be planned as follows:

Phase	Activity	Estimated Duration
1	Requirement Analysis	1 Day
2	Spreadsheet Preparation	1 Day
3	ServiceNow Configuration	2 Days
4	Transform Map & Field Mapping	2 Days
5	Transformation & Validation	1 Day
6	Testing	2 Days
7	Error Correction	1 Day
8	Final Verification & Documentation	1 Day

Total Estimated Duration: 11 Working Days

The actual timeline can be adjusted based on data volume and project complexity.

6. Resource Planning

The project requires the following resources:

Human Resources

- **Project Manager** – Manages project activities and schedule.
- **ServiceNow Developer/Administrator** – Configures Import Sets and Transform Maps.
- **Business Analyst** – Defines data and business requirements.
- **Tester** – Performs functional and validation testing.
- **Business/User Representative** – Validates the final imported data.

Technical Resources

- ServiceNow instance.
- Excel or CSV spreadsheet.
- Test data.
- Target ServiceNow table.
- Appropriate user roles and permissions.

7. Responsibility Assignment

Activity	Responsible Role
Requirement gathering	Business Analyst
Project planning	Project Manager
Spreadsheet preparation	Business/User
ServiceNow configuration	ServiceNow Developer
Transform Map configuration	ServiceNow Developer
Data validation	Developer / Tester
Functional testing	Tester
User acceptance testing	Business User
Final approval	Project Manager / Business Owner
Documentation	Developer / Business Analyst

8. Data Preparation Plan

Before importing the spreadsheet, the data should be reviewed and cleaned.

The preparation process includes:

- Removing unnecessary columns.
- Checking mandatory fields.

- Removing unwanted blank rows.
- Checking duplicate identifiers.
- Validating email addresses.
- Checking date formats.
- Standardizing department names.
- Ensuring consistent field values.

This reduces the possibility of transformation failures.

9. Testing Plan

Testing will be performed in multiple stages.

Unit Testing

Test individual configurations such as:

- Field mappings.
- Coalesce settings.
- Transformation logic.
- Validation rules.

Integration Testing

Test the complete flow:

Spreadsheet → Import Set → Transform Map → Target Table

User Acceptance Testing

Business users will verify that:

- Imported data is correct.
- Existing records are updated correctly.
- New records are created correctly.
- Invalid records are handled appropriately.
- Target table data meets business requirements.

10. Risk Management

Potential risks and mitigation plans are:

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Incorrect spreadsheet format	Import failure	Provide a standard template
Missing mandatory data	Failed transformation	Validate before import

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Duplicate records	Data inconsistency	Use Coalesce
Incorrect field mapping	Wrong target data	Perform mapping verification
Invalid reference values	Transformation failure	Validate reference data
Large data volume	Longer processing time	Test performance beforehand
Unauthorized import	Security risk	Configure appropriate roles
Transformation errors	Incorrect records	Perform detailed testing

11. Quality Plan

The project should maintain data quality throughout the import process.

Quality checks include:

- Correct source-to-target mapping.
- Accurate data transformation.
- Mandatory field validation.
- Duplicate detection.
- Error identification.
- Target record verification.
- User acceptance testing.

The imported data should match the expected source data after transformation.

12. Communication Plan

Project communication should be maintained throughout the implementation.

Regular communication should cover:

- Project progress.
- Configuration status.
- Testing results.
- Identified issues.
- Risk updates.
- Required changes.
- Final approval.

A simple progress report can be maintained to track each project activity.

13. Deliverables

The major project deliverables will include:

1. Requirement document.
2. Standard spreadsheet template.
3. Data Source configuration.
4. Import Set configuration.
5. Import Set Table.
6. Transform Map.
7. Field mapping configuration.
8. Transformation rules.
9. Coalesce configuration.
10. Test cases and test results.
11. Error-handling documentation.
12. Final project documentation.

14. Project Completion Criteria

The project will be considered complete when:

- The spreadsheet can be successfully uploaded.
- Import Set data is created correctly.
- Transform Map executes successfully.
- Source fields are mapped correctly.
- Data transformation works as expected.
- Duplicate records are handled correctly.
- New records are inserted correctly.
- Existing records are updated correctly.
- Invalid records are identified.
- Testing is completed successfully.
- Business users approve the imported data.
- Final documentation is completed.

15. Overall Project Plan

The complete project plan can be represented as:

```
Requirement Analysis
        ↓
Spreadsheet Preparation
        ↓
ServiceNow Configuration
        ↓
Import Set Creation
        ↓
Import Set Table Configuration
        ↓
```

```
Transform Map Creation
        ↓
Field Mapping
        ↓
Transformation & Coalesce
        ↓
Testing
        ↓
Error Correction
        ↓
User Acceptance Testing
        ↓
Final Verification
        ↓
Documentation & Completion
```

16. Final Project Planning Statement

The Project Planning Phase establishes a structured approach for implementing the “Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)” solution in ServiceNow. The plan covers requirements, project scope, activities, resources, timeline, responsibilities, data preparation, testing, risk management, quality assurance, and deliverables. The project will follow a controlled process from spreadsheet preparation through Import Set configuration, Transform Map implementation, testing, validation, and final deployment. This planning approach ensures that the data import process is completed efficiently, accurately, and according to the defined business requirements.